Grant Proposal 1: An Open Trust Network

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Vision. A world where everyone is kept safe, left free, treated fairly, and helped to grow, belong, and contribute by one another. In that world, moral good is the norm, and moral evil is unprofitable, unviable, and rare.

The problem. Almost everyone has been lied to, cheated, used, or hurt on purpose, and too often moral evil is rewarded: those who do it keep what they gain and face few consequences. AI and robots will likely run most of our systems in the near future. If moral evil is still rewarded then, they will do it faster and at a much larger scale than humans can, and we may not be able to stop them. One reason moral evil is rewarded is that those dealing with strangers cannot see how those strangers have treated others before. This is one of the problems to be solved.

What I'm building. An open trust network. Members, whether people, businesses, AI, or robots, write signed entries about what one party did to or for another. Any change or erasure would be visible to everyone, and anyone can read what others wrote about a member. Doing moral good can then earn more deals, better terms, and a better quality of life. Doing moral evil can lose its gain, its helpers, and its access. No one will control the network, including me. The open record is the first part to be built, and more parts would be built as the work shows what is needed.

The plan in simple words. The network starts with a small group who wants to deal in moral good. As the network grows, it will be openly reported how members are doing compared with non-members. When members are better off in terms of their quality of life, more non-members would likely want to join. Growth is expected to be very slow at the start, then have a snowball effect as it scales worldwide.

The main risk for now. The network only works if people, businesses, and AI check the record of who they're dealing with before doing so. The first test is built to show whether they do, early and cheaply.

Why me. In my structural engineering job, my boss privately asked me to make a failed structure appear to pass so we could get paid. I realized he cared only about the money, not the people who would die if it failed. I resigned instead. I faced many similar experiences in different places with different people in which I learned how the real world works. The common thing is moral evil. All the most painful problems I experienced are from the ripple effects of moral evil, which drew me to work on this project. I'm determined to make the vision a reality fast, and to build it so it outlasts me.

The request. $10,000, over about 3 months, for:

1. A working prototype of the network's open record of entries.
2. A small group that I will recruit, such as food and beverage wholesalers and their buyers, who record their actual orders and deliveries on the network.
3. A public report of what happened, including how many people joined and what did not work.

The money covers my living costs so I can work full-time, AI tools and hosting, and a reserve, which may include legal and/or software reviews. I will report results, good or bad, before asking for more money. I can receive funds as an individual, and I will set up an entity once the first test gives positive results.

For more detail: My Open Manifesto · Rough Timeline Plan